DIGITALKARTAI.SHOP | DIGITAL EDITION

The PM Internship Scheme 2026 Handbook

Your Rs. 9,000-a-Month Path into India's Top Companies

Verified from the Ministry of Corporate Affairs

Revised PMIS guidelines (12 March 2026) and Round III - live till December 2026

Updated October 2026

About this handbook

This is a plain-English, step-by-step guide to the Prime Minister's Internship Scheme (PMIS) - the Government of India programme that places young people aged 18 to 25 into paid internships at the country's largest companies. If you are a graduate, a final-year student, or someone who has finished Class 10, Class 12, ITI or a diploma, and you want six to nine months of real work experience with a monthly stipend of Rs. 9,000, this handbook walks you through every step - from your first login to your completion certificate.

Everything here is written from official sources and checked against the most recent rules. The scheme changed significantly in March 2026, and much of what circulates on the internet is still describing the old version. This handbook uses the current version.

> **What this handbook is not**
> It is not an official government publication and it is not affiliated with the Ministry of Corporate Affairs. It is an independent guide to help you use the official scheme well. The official portal is always the final authority on your application, eligibility and payments.

Sources used

The facts in this handbook are drawn from: the PMIS portal (pminternship.mca.gov.in) and its candidate and company manuals; the Ministry of Corporate Affairs PMIS Pilot Project guidelines, including the revised Office Memorandum dated 12 March 2026; the University Grants Commission PMIS guidelines; Press Information Bureau releases; and official replies given in Parliament (Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha) during 2026. Where a figure has a date, the date is given so you can see how current it is.

> **The 60-second summary**
> PMIS is a paid internship scheme, not a job. You register free on the official portal, complete Aadhaar e-KYC, build a profile, and apply to live internships. You can hold up to 3 active applications and up to 2 offers, and you accept only 1. You get Rs. 9,000 a month (Rs. 900 from the company, Rs. 8,100 from the government via DBT) plus a one-time Rs. 6,000 grant, free insurance, and a completion certificate. Internships run 6 or 9 months. There is no fee, ever.

Contents

01	What the PM Internship Scheme actually is
02	The pilot round by round: what the data teaches you
03	The March 2026 reset: why most guides online are wrong
04	Myths and facts about PMIS
05	Are you eligible? The complete filter
06	What you actually get: money, insurance, certificate
07	Sectors and roles: where the opportunities are
08	The portal, step by step
09	The 3-2-1 rule: how the application engine works
10	Picking internships that actually convert
11	How to get shortlisted when thousands apply
12	The company round: assessments and interviews
13	Offer, acceptance and joining
14	Getting paid: DBT and your bank account
15	Your rights: what every company must provide
16	Thriving during the internship
17	Certificates, PPO and what comes after
18	PMIS compared: apprenticeships and other schemes
19	The rules you must not break
20	Scams, fees and red flags
21	The 10 mistakes that cost youth their internship
22	Your 30-day action plan
23	Questions youth actually ask (FAQ)
24	Templates you can copy
25	Glossary of portal terms
26	Official links and sources
27	Quick reference: the whole scheme on one page

Rs. 9,000
PER MONTH
Monthly stipend for the full internship

Rs. 6,000
ONE-TIME
Joining grant, paid in two tranches

6 or 9
MONTHS
Internship duration under current rules

01 What the PM Internship Scheme actually is

PMIS is a government programme that puts young Indians into paid internships at big companies for six to nine months, so they leave with real work experience, a monthly stipend and a certificate. It was announced in the Union Budget 2024-25 and launched on 3 October 2024 by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA). The long-term goal is one crore internships over five years.

It is important to be clear about what it is not. PMIS is not a job. It does not promise employment at the end. It is a structured internship: you learn inside a real business, a supervisor or mentor is assigned to you, and at least half the time is meant to be spent doing actual work rather than sitting in training. It is also not a government-run classroom course. You are placed inside a private company - Reliance, TCS, HDFC Bank, Maruti Suzuki, Infosys, L&T; and hundreds of others have taken part.

Why the government built it

India has millions of graduates every year and a persistent gap between what colleges teach and what employers need. The scheme is designed to close that gap by giving young people their first real line on a resume. It is deliberately aimed at youth who lack network access to corporate roles - the scheme reaches tier-2 and tier-3 cities, rural and semi-urban districts, and it prioritises representation for SC, ST, OBC and Persons with Disabilities candidates in the shortlisting process.

How it is running right now

The full scheme has not yet launched. What is live is a pilot project, extended to run until December 2026. The pilot has completed two rounds and Round III began on 20 March 2026 under revised guidelines. Round III is the one open to you today. It runs on a rolling model: companies post new internships continuously rather than in a single window, so you can register and apply at any time while the round is open.

3.68 lakh
OPPORTUNITIES POSTED
Across Rounds I, II and III (as of 15 Jul 2026)

13.38 lakh
APPLICATIONS
Received across the three pilot rounds

340
COMPANIES
Participating in Round III as of 15 Jul 2026

Those numbers tell you something useful: the scheme is large, but only a fraction of offers turn into completed internships. In Round I, 82,077 offers were made but only 3,730 internships were completed. That is not because youth were rejected - it is mostly because candidates did not accept offers, did not join, or dropped out. Which means: if you understand the process and follow through, you are competing against people who do not.

> **The one thing to remember**
> PMIS rewards follow-through. The scheme is full of candidates who register and then go quiet. If you complete your profile, apply thoughtfully, and accept and join an offer within the deadlines, you are already ahead of most of the field.

02 The pilot round by round: what the data teaches you

PMIS has run three pilot rounds, and each one is a lesson in what works and what does not. Reading the numbers is the fastest way to understand why the scheme is built the way it is today - and how to place yourself on the winning side of it.

Round	Opportunities posted	Applications	Offers made	Completed / joined
Round I	1,27,508	6,21,962	82,077	3,730 completed
Round II	1,18,948	4,55,267	83,696	2,689 completed
Round III (ongoing)	1,22,148	2,60,747	20,532	10,195 joined
Total	3,68,604	13,37,976	1,86,305	6,419 completed + 10,195 joined

Figures as of 15 July 2026, from Ministry of Corporate Affairs data tabled in Parliament.

The lesson hiding in the numbers

Look at the gap between offers and completions. In Round I, 82,077 offers produced only 3,730 completed internships. In Round II, 83,696 offers produced 2,689. The scheme is not short of opportunities or offers - it is short of candidates who accept an offer and see it through. That is your opening. If you simply finish what you start, you are in a small minority that the scheme badly wants.

Why offers were declined

The government investigated and found three dominant reasons: candidates preferred internships within 5 to 10 km of home; the original 12-month duration felt too long compared with normal skilling programmes; and some candidates simply were not interested in the roles offered. Notice that none of these is about being rejected. Youth were declining seats they had won.

What the government changed as a result

- Stipend raised from Rs. 5,000 to Rs. 9,000 a month.
- Duration shortened from a fixed 12 months to 6 or 9 months.
- Age band widened from 21-24 to 18-25.
- Final-year students and postgraduates brought into scope.
- More companies made eligible, and a rolling model introduced so opportunities keep coming.

> **Your strategic takeaway**
>
> The single highest-value behaviour in PMIS is follow-through. Apply to internships you would genuinely join, respond fast, accept what you will honour, and complete it. Everything else - the money, the certificate, the reference, the chance of a job offer - follows from that one habit.

03 The March 2026 reset: why most guides online are wrong

The rules changed on 12 March 2026, and a large share of the advice you will find on the internet is still describing the old scheme. If you read that PMIS pays Rs. 5,000 a month, lasts 12 months, or is open only to ages 21 to 24, you are reading last year's rules. Here is exactly what changed and what is true now.

Feature	Old rules (before March 2026)	Current rules (Round III)
Monthly stipend	Rs. 5,000 (Rs. 4,500 govt + Rs. 500 company)	Rs. 9,000 (Rs. 8,100 govt + Rs. 900 company)
Internship duration	12 months, fixed	6 or 9 months, based on the company's requirement
Age band	21 to 24 years	18 to 25 years
Who can apply	Graduates and school/ITI/diploma pass-outs	Also final-year graduates/PGs and master's degree holders
Application model	Fixed rounds with closing dates	Rolling - companies post continuously
Eligible companies	Top 500 by CSR spend	Top 2,000 by CSR, plus firms with turnover over Rs. 1,000 crore or net worth over Rs. 500 crore, plus GCCs, SEZs, select MSMEs and others

Why the change matters to you

The government made these changes after studying why so many offers were being declined. Its own feedback survey found three main reasons: candidates wanted internships close to home (ideally within 5 to 10 km), 12 months felt too long compared with normal skilling programmes, and some candidates were not interested in the roles offered. The higher stipend, shorter duration and wider age band are the direct answer to that.

For you, the practical effect is that the scheme is now easier to enter and better paid than at any point in its history. It is also broader: a final-year student who could not apply before can now apply, and so can someone with a master's degree (with one important exception - see the next section).

> **Watch out for outdated content**
> Any blog, YouTube video or Telegram forward that says Rs. 5,000, 12 months, or age 21-24 is out of date. The current numbers are Rs. 9,000, 6 or 9 months, and age 18-25. Always confirm on the official portal before you act.

04 Myths and facts about PMIS

A lot of wrong information circulates about this scheme, mostly because the rules changed in March 2026. Here are the myths you are most likely to hear, and what is actually true.

The myth	The fact
"PMIS pays Rs. 5,000 a month."	It pays Rs. 9,000 a month since March 2026, plus a one-time Rs. 6,000 grant.
"The internship lasts one year."	New internships run 6 or 9 months. Only interns from earlier rounds continue at 12 months.
"You must be 21 to apply."	The age band is 18 to 25 as of March 2026.
"Only graduates can apply."	Class 10/12 pass-outs, ITI certificate holders, diploma holders, graduates and postgraduates can all apply.
"It guarantees you a job."	It does not. A company may voluntarily give a PPO or PO after 50% completion, but that is not guaranteed.
"You can register through an agent for a fee."	Registration is free on the official portal only. Anyone charging a fee is a scam.
"You can apply to as many internships as you like."	You can hold at most 3 active applications and 2 offers, and accept only 1.
"Final-year students cannot apply."	They can, since March 2026, with an institutional NoC.
"An MBA holder can apply."	MBA and equivalent management qualifications are excluded.
"You get paid into any bank account."	Only an Aadhaar-seeded bank account receives the DBT payments.

When in doubt, check the portal

Misinformation about PMIS is common because the scheme changed. Before you act on anything you read or hear, confirm it on pminternship.mca.gov.in - the portal is the only authority on your eligibility and your payments.

05 Are you eligible? The complete filter

PMIS uses a set of hard filters. If you fail any one of them, the portal will not let your application through. The good news is that the filters are simple to check, and the March 2026 revision widened them. Go through this list honestly before you register.

You are eligible if all of these are true

- You are an Indian citizen.
- You are between 18 and 25 years old on the date you apply.
- You are not in full-time employment.
- You are not enrolled in a full-time, regular course (distance and online learners are allowed, and so are final-year students - see below).
- You have passed at least Class 10, or hold an ITI certificate, a polytechnic diploma, or a degree (BA, B.Sc, B.Com, BCA, BBA, B.Pharma, B.E/B.Tech, and so on) or a master's degree.
- Your family's annual income is under Rs. 12 lakh in the preceding financial year (family means you, your parents and your spouse).

The eligibility edge cases that trip people up

Your situation	Are you eligible?
Final-year student of a full-time graduation or post-graduation course	Yes - explicitly allowed since March 2026, but you must upload a No-Objection Certificate (NoC) from your institution.
Enrolled in an online or distance-learning programme	Yes - online and distance learners are eligible.
Holding a master's degree (MA, M.Sc, M.Com, MCA, M.Tech)	Yes - postgraduates were made eligible in March 2026.
Holding an MBA or equivalent	No - MBA and equivalent management qualifications are excluded.
Graduate of an IIT, IIM, NLU, IISER, NID, IIIT or IISc	No - graduates of these institutes are excluded.
Holding CA, CMA, CS, MBBS, BDS or a PhD	No - these professional and doctoral qualifications are excluded.
Already completed an apprenticeship or training under NAPS or NATS	No - those who have done so at any point are excluded.
A family member holds a permanent government job	No - this is a disqualifier under the scheme's conditions.
Currently doing a government internship	No - you cannot hold another government internship at the same time.

One more rule on income: the family income limit is Rs. 12 lakh per year, and it applies to the combined income of you, your parents and your spouse. You confirm this through a self-declaration on the portal - no separate income certificate is required for the scheme itself. Be accurate. The portal cross-checks details where it can, and a false declaration can invalidate your application.

> **The reason for the exclusions**
>
> PMIS is built to reach first-generation aspirants and youth from tier-2 and tier-3 backgrounds who lack network access to corporate roles. That is why premium-institute graduates and professional-degree holders are filtered out - the scheme is not designed for people who already have an easier route in.

06 What you actually get: money, insurance, certificate

The financial package under PMIS is straightforward, and every rupee of it is set by the government - not negotiated by the company. Here is exactly what an intern receives.

The monthly stipend: Rs. 9,000

For the entire duration of the internship you receive Rs. 9,000 a month. It is paid in two parts. Every month the company releases Rs. 900 (10% of the total) from its CSR funds or its own funds. Once the company has paid its share, the government pays Rs. 8,100 directly into your Aadhaar-seeded bank account through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT).

- The company's Rs. 900 can be linked to your attendance and to your adherence to company policies - so turning up matters.
- The government's Rs. 8,100 is pro-rated to match what the company has actually paid.
- If a company chooses to pay you more than Rs. 900, it can - from its own funds. Some do.

The one-time grant: Rs. 6,000

Beyond the monthly stipend, every intern gets a one-time incidental grant of Rs. 6,000, paid in two tranches of Rs. 3,000. The first tranche is released within 15 days of the company confirming your joining. The second is released within 15 days of you completing three months of the internship. Both come by DBT to your Aadhaar-seeded account.

Insurance: free, and worth knowing about

The government provides every intern life and personal-accident insurance equivalent to the cover under two national schemes: Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY) and Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY). The premium is paid by the government. The accident cover is aligned to PMSBY benefits (Rs. 2 lakh on accidental death or total disability, Rs. 1 lakh on partial disability). A company may add extra insurance of its own on top.

The certificate

At the end you receive a certificate, issued through the portal by the company and MCA. There are two types. A Participation Certificate unlocks once you have completed at least 50% of the internship - this is what you get if you exit early because you were offered a job. A Completion Certificate requires you to finish 100% of the internship. Certificates carry a secure QR code for verification, and you download them from your own login.

Rs. 8,100	Rs. 900	Rs. 6,000
GOVT SHARE	COMPANY SHARE	JOINING GRANT
Monthly, via DBT	Monthly, from CSR/own funds	Two tranches of Rs. 3,000

What is not guaranteed

The scheme does not promise a job at the end, and it does not guarantee that the company will offer you one. However, companies may voluntarily give a Pre-Placement Offer (PPO) or a Placement Offer (PO) to strong performers after at least 50% of the internship is done. This is entirely at the company's discretion - but it happens, and it is one of the best reasons to treat the internship as a real job interview.

07 Sectors and roles: where the opportunities are

PMIS opportunities are spread across roughly two dozen sectors, and the sector you choose shapes the skills you build and the resume line you walk away with. Knowing where the volume is helps you aim your three application slots well.

The sectors you will see on the portal

Agriculture and allied; Automotive; Aviation and Defence; Banking and Financial Services; Cement and Building Materials; Chemicals; Consulting; Diversified Conglomerates; FMCG; Gems and Jewellery; Healthcare; Housing; Infrastructure and Construction; IT and Software Development; Leather; Manufacturing and Industrial; Media, Entertainment and Education; Metals and Mining; Oil, Gas and Energy; Pharmaceuticals; Retail and Consumer Durables; Sports; Telecom; Textile Manufacturing; and Travel and Hospitality.

Where the most opportunities are

In Round III, the states posting the largest numbers of internships were Tamil Nadu (about 15,700), Uttar Pradesh (about 11,280), Telangana (about 6,480), Andhra Pradesh (about 6,380), Maharashtra, Karnataka, Odisha and Rajasthan. Internships exist in all 735 districts, so even if you are far from a metro there is usually something within reach - and the portal lets you filter by state, district and even by distance from where you live.

How to read an internship listing

- Role and function: what you will actually do day to day - check this first, not the company logo.
- Minimum qualification: the portal warns you if your background does not align. Heed the warning.
- Location: the portal geo-tags it and shows how far it is from you. Think about the commute before you apply.
- Duration: 6 or 9 months. Confirm which.
- Additional benefits: accommodation, transport, canteen, insurance or extra stipend - some companies list these, and they matter.

The big-name partners

Among the largest providers of PMIS opportunities have been Reliance Industries, Tata Consultancy Services, HDFC Bank, Maruti Suzuki and Infosys, alongside hundreds of other firms. But a smaller company close to home will often give you more hands-on work than a famous one far away. Weigh the brand against the role and the distance - and remember that a completed internship at any company beats an abandoned one at a famous one.

> **Aim for the resume line, not the logo**
>
> Ask yourself: in nine months, what will I be able to write on my resume, and what will I be able to talk about in my next interview? Choose the internship that gives you the best answer to that, not the one with the most recognisable name.

08 The portal, step by step

Everything happens on one website: pminternship.mca.gov.in. There is also an official PMIS mobile app. There is no offline route and no authorised agent - any website that charges a fee to register you is not genuine. Here is the full journey, in order.

1. **Open the official portal.** Go to pminternship.mca.gov.in and click Login / Register. New users select Register Now.
2. **Register with your mobile number.** Enter an Aadhaar-linked mobile number, give consent, and verify with the OTP you receive. Then set a password (at least 8 characters, with an uppercase letter, a lowercase letter, a digit and a special character).
3. **Complete e-KYC.** Verify your identity either through Aadhaar OTP or through DigiLocker. This step is what unlocks the full internship details and the Apply button.
4. **Build your profile.** Fill in personal details, your education history in order, your skills and your language proficiency. The portal auto-generates a standard CV from what you enter - so what you type is what companies see.
5. **Upload your documents.** Keep your Aadhaar, your latest educational certificates, a recent passport-size photograph (optional) and - if you are a final-year student - your institution's NoC ready as PDFs.
6. **Set your preferences.** Choose the sectors, roles and locations you want. The portal matches internships to your preferences and qualifications.
7. **Search and apply.** Filter internships by state, district, sector or keyword. Apply to the ones that genuinely match you (remember the 3-active-application limit in the next section).
8. **Track everything on your dashboard.** Your Candidate Dashboard shows the status of every application - applied, shortlisted, waitlisted, selected, offer accepted, joined.
9. **If selected, manage your offer.** Accept within 14 days. Then complete the joining steps on the portal.

> **Documents to keep ready before you start**
>
> Aadhaar card (linked to an active mobile number); educational certificates - Class 10/12 marksheets, ITI or diploma certificates, or your degree certificate; a bank account seeded with your Aadhaar for DBT; DigiLocker access for faster e-KYC; and a NoC from your institution if you are a final-year student.

Using the mobile app

The PMIS mobile app was launched on 17 March 2025 and does the same things as the website - register, complete e-KYC, browse and apply to internships. It also carries a referral programme: registered users can refer eligible candidates and earn rewards. If you prefer your phone, the app is a perfectly valid route.

If something goes wrong

The portal has several support channels. Use the Need Help chat assistant at the bottom-right corner of the portal, raise a ticket via Home > Support > Raise Request, or file a grievance from the Complaints section in your dashboard. The official multilingual helpline is 1800-11-6090, and the official email is pminternship@mca.gov.in. User manuals and guidance videos are on the homepage.

09 The 3-2-1 rule: how the application engine works

PMIS runs on a strict set of system rules that decide what you can do and when. The single most useful way to remember them is the 3-2-1 rule: three applications, two offers, one acceptance. Understand this and you will not accidentally lock yourself out of the scheme.

Three active applications

You can have a maximum of three active internship applications at any one time. An application counts as active while it is in progress - applied by you, shortlisted, waitlisted by the company, selected by the company, offer accepted, or joined. If one of your applications is rejected or not shortlisted, it frees up a slot and you can apply again - but you can never hold more than three at once.

Two offers, one acceptance

You can receive a maximum of two active offer letters at one time, but you can accept only one. Once you accept an offer, your other applications and offers are blocked and you can no longer apply to new internships. This is why you should apply to internships you would genuinely join.

The deadline that ends everything: 14 days

If a company sends you an offer, you must accept or reject it within 14 days. If you take no action, the offer lapses automatically on day 15 and the seat goes to the next candidate. There is one piece of flexibility: if you have accepted one offer and then receive a second, you may withdraw the first and accept the other - but only within 15 days of accepting the first.

Rule	Limit	What it means for you
Active applications	3 at a time	Choose carefully; a rejected one frees a slot
Active offers you can hold	2 at a time	You cannot accept both
Offers you can accept	1	Accepting blocks all other applications
Days to accept an offer	14	Lapse on day 15 if you do nothing
Days to switch an accepted offer	15	Only if you received a second offer

> **Why the rules exist**
> They keep the system fair. Every active application you hold is a seat another candidate cannot use. The limits stop a few candidates from hoarding dozens of offers and leaving seats empty - which is exactly what happened in the early rounds.

10 Picking internships that actually convert

Most youth who lose their PMIS internship lose it before they ever apply - by choosing internships they were never going to accept or join. The government's own data is blunt about this: the top reasons offers were declined were location (candidates wanted internships within 5 to 10 km of home), duration, and a lack of interest in the role. Choose against those three factors and your conversion rate rises immediately.

Start with distance

The portal geo-tags internship locations and warns you when an internship is far from where you live. Take those warnings seriously. If an internship is 400 km away and you have no plan for accommodation or travel, you are unlikely to join - so do not spend one of your three application slots on it. Aim for internships you can realistically reach every working day, or ones where the company clearly offers accommodation or transport.

Match your qualification, not your ambition

The portal also warns you when your academic background does not fully align with a role. A listing that asks for a B.Tech in ECE is not the one for a B.Com student, however much you want the company name. Precision beats volume. Applying to roles you are clearly underqualified for wastes your three slots and lowers your response rate.

Think about the sector, not just the brand

PMIS spans around 24 sectors - IT and software, banking and finance, oil and gas, automotive, FMCG, telecom, pharma, healthcare, retail, manufacturing, media and more. The right question is not which company is the most famous, but which sector you can actually see yourself working in for six to nine months, and which role will look good on your resume afterwards.

Use all three slots, across different bets

Do not put all three active applications on the same company or the same city. Spread them: one close to home, one in your target sector, one at a larger brand if it fits. That way a single rejection does not wipe out your whole plan.

> **A simple test before you apply**
>
> Ask: if this internship offered me a place tomorrow, would I genuinely pack my bag and join? If the answer is no, do not apply. Your three slots are precious, and an offer you will not accept takes a seat away from someone who would.

11 How to get shortlisted when thousands apply

There is no entrance exam for PMIS. Selection is profile-based: the portal shortlists a pool for each internship, and companies then choose from that pool using their own criteria. That means your profile and your application quality are the whole game. Here is how to make yours stand out.

Complete your profile to 100%

This is the single highest-return action. Companies can filter applicants by profile completeness, and an incomplete profile - missing skills, no generated CV, blank fields - gets skipped by the matching engine before a human ever sees it. Fill every field, including the optional ones: skills, language proficiency and a short bio.

Name your skills concretely

Write 'Basic Excel' rather than 'proficient in MS tools'. Write 'Hindi, English, Marathi' rather than 'good communication'. Specific, honest skill names match better and survive verification. Do not inflate: companies may check.

Add verifiable certifications

Free certificates carry real weight. Courses from SWAYAM or NPTEL, or sector-specific certifications, strengthen your profile at no cost. If you have completed any, list them. If you have none, a short free course before you apply is time well spent.

Keep a clean one-page resume

The portal generates a standard CV from your profile, but where you can add your own resume, keep it to one page: education, two or three projects or experiences, and skills. No photo, no objective statement, just facts. If you have no work experience, lead with skills, education and certifications.

Apply in your first week, and be responsive

Do not apply to one listing and wait. Apply to several relevant listings across different companies and cities in your first week. Then watch your phone and email: some companies contact shortlisted candidates within 48 to 72 hours, and if you miss that window the seat goes to the next person. Keep your Aadhaar-linked mobile reachable and check your dashboard daily.

> **The diversity edge**
>
> The portal's shortlisting process deliberately promotes broader representation, giving weight to SC, ST, OBC and PwD candidates and to candidates from under-represented regions. If you fall into any of these groups, apply with confidence - the system is designed to give you a fair look, not to filter you out.

12 The company round: assessments and interviews

Once the portal shortlists you for an internship, the company takes over. Companies are free to use their own selection process, and the guidelines explicitly allow assessments or interviews as the company deems appropriate. Not every company runs an interview - many select directly from profiles - but you should be ready for one.

What the company round usually looks like

- Profile screening: the company reviews the shortlisted candidates and their resumes.
- A short assessment or an interview: some companies hold a brief online assessment, others a short conversation. These are usually about communication, motivation and role awareness - not deep technical knowledge.
- Selection and offer: the company selects, records its decision on the portal, and issues an offer letter through the portal.

How to prepare in an hour

- Read the internship listing again and be able to say in two sentences what the role is and why you want it.
- Know one or two things about the company - its sector, what it does, roughly how big it is.
- Prepare a 60-second introduction about yourself: your education, one thing you have done, and what you want to learn.
- Have a quiet place, a working phone or laptop, and your documents within reach.
- Be honest about what you do not know. Interviewers are checking attitude and reliability, not expertise.

What happens after the company decides

All actions relating to selection, rejection or waitlisting are recorded on the portal, and the company must give a reason for rejection. That transparency protects you: you can always see your status on your dashboard, and you can raise a grievance if something looks wrong.

> **Rejections are normal**
> Companies shortlist a pool several times the size of the available seats, so most candidates are rejected for most roles. A rejection does not affect your account - it simply frees an application slot for you to use on the next internship. Treat each one as routine and keep applying.

13 Offer, acceptance and joining

The offer stage is where careful candidates separate themselves from the rest. Everything here is timed, and the clock does not wait. Read this section before you apply, not after you get an offer.

1. **You receive an offer.** A congratulatory pop-up appears, and the internship row in your dashboard shows a selection status such as 'Selected by HR', with action buttons: View Letter, Accept Offer and Reject Offer.
2. **Read the offer letter.** Click View Letter and read it carefully - the role, the location, the joining/reporting instructions, the timelines and any documents required. Never accept before reading.
3. **Accept or reject within 14 days.** Click Accept Offer and confirm. Your status becomes 'Offer Accepted by Candidate'. If you do nothing for 14 days, the offer lapses automatically.
4. **Switch only if you must.** If a second offer arrives after you have accepted one, you may withdraw the first and accept the other - but only within 15 days of your first acceptance.
5. **Join on or before the reporting date.** Report on the date in the offer letter. If you cannot, you get a 14-day grace period. If you still do not join, the system marks you 'Did Not Report' (DNR) automatically on day 15.

The DNR trap

Did Not Report is the most avoidable way to damage your standing. If you accept an offer and then simply do not turn up, the portal records it. Repeated offer lapses, rejections and DNRs can lead to a temporary restriction on your account. If your plans change, reject the offer on the portal rather than going silent - that frees the seat for someone else and keeps your record clean.

Joining day: what to carry

- Your offer letter and any joining instructions from the company.
- Aadhaar and your original educational certificates.
- Your Aadhaar-seeded bank account details - the stipend and grant are paid only to a seeded account.
- A few passport-size photographs, in case the company's onboarding needs them.

> **The 48-hour habit**
> Once you have applied anywhere, check your dashboard, phone and email at least once every day. The offer window is 14 days, but companies can move faster than that, and the candidates who join are the ones who respond first.

14 Getting paid: DBT and your bank account

PMIS is a Direct Benefit Transfer scheme. That means the government's share of your money does not pass through anyone's hands - it is credited straight to your bank account. But DBT only works if your account is set up correctly. Get this right before you join, or your first payments will be delayed.

The one requirement: an Aadhaar-seeded bank account

Your bank account must be seeded with your Aadhaar - that is, your Aadhaar number must be linked to the account in the bank's records. This is how the government verifies that the money is reaching the right person. Aadhaar seeding is standard for DBT across all government schemes.

How the money flows each month

1. The company releases its Rs. 900 share from CSR or own funds, based on your attendance and conduct.
2. The company uploads the payment details on the portal - partner companies are required to do this before the 5th of every month.
3. Once the company's payment is recorded, the government pays its Rs. 8,100 share to your Aadhaar-seeded account by DBT.
4. The government's share is pro-rated to match what the company actually paid.

Your one-time grant, in two parts

The Rs. 6,000 incidental grant also comes by DBT. The first Rs. 3,000 is released within 15 days of the company confirming your joining on the portal. The second Rs. 3,000 is released within 15 days of you completing three months. Both are automatic once the milestones are recorded - but only if your account is seeded.

> **Do this in week one**
> Visit your bank or use your bank's app and confirm that your Aadhaar is seeded to your account. If it is not, seed it now. Interns whose accounts are not seeded are the ones whose stipends get stuck, and a stuck stipend is entirely avoidable.

If a payment is late

Start with the company - the Rs. 8,100 government share is triggered only after the company uploads its Rs. 900 payment. If the company has paid but your DBT has not arrived, raise it on the portal: use the Complaints section, selecting the correct category (DBT, Internship or Portal), keep the description clear, and upload supporting files. If you cannot resolve it on the portal, call the helpline on 1800-11-6090.

15 Your rights: what every company must provide

PMIS is not a favour - it is a structured programme with obligations on the company as well as on you. Knowing what the company must provide protects you from being treated as unpaid help or as a general dogsbody.

What companies are required to do

- Provide relevant training: companies must give interns training, and at least half the internship period must be spent in the actual working environment - not sitting in a classroom.
- Assign a supervisor or mentor to each intern on joining.
- Pay their share of the monthly allowance and upload the payment details on the portal in time, before the 5th of each month.
- Upload a training plan and a Quarterly Progress Report (QPR) for you on the portal.
- Record every selection, rejection or waitlisting decision on the portal, with a reason for rejection.
- Issue your certificate at the end - a Participation Certificate after 50% completion or a Completion Certificate after 100%.
- Maintain a grievance mechanism, with a nodal officer as the appellate authority.

What companies may provide, but are not required to

Accommodation or hostel, transport, food or canteen, health and wellness facilities, recreational facilities, extra insurance beyond the government's PMJJBY/PMSBY cover, and additional financial assistance above Rs. 900 a month. Where a company offers these, they must be clearly stated in the internship listing under 'Additional Benefits'.

What you are not

You are an intern, not an employee. PMIS interns are not treated as employees, and the scheme is separate from apprenticeship and employment programmes. That also means your internship does not automatically count as work experience for every purpose - but it does give you a certificate, a reference and real skills, which is what matters to most employers.

> **If a company is not meeting its obligations**
> Raise it. Use the grievance section on the portal, contact your nodal officer, or call the helpline on 1800-11-6090. The system records company obligations and failures - you do not have to accept a role that is not what was advertised.

16 Thriving during the internship

Joining is not the finish line - completing is. Remember the numbers from earlier: in Round I, 82,077 offers became only 3,730 completed internships. Finishing well is what turns an internship into a certificate, a reference and possibly a job offer. Here is how to be the intern who finishes well.

The mechanics of staying in the scheme

- Attendance is the foundation. The company's Rs. 900 share is linked to your attendance and to your adherence to company policies.
- Follow company rules on working hours, leave, punctuality, conduct, confidentiality and dress code. Non-compliance can lead to a warning, suspension or termination - and a terminated intern cannot participate in PMIS again.
- A supervisor or mentor is assigned to you on joining. Use them. Ask questions, ask for feedback, and let them see you improving.
- The company must upload a training plan and a Quarterly Progress Report (QPR) for you on the portal. Cooperate with these - they are how your progress is officially recorded.

How to make it count

- Treat it as a nine-month interview. The PPO/PO window opens after 50% completion - a company that likes you can offer you a job.
- Keep a simple weekly log of what you did and what you learned. It becomes your resume bullet points and your interview stories.
- Ask for one thing at a time: a new task, a small responsibility, a chance to sit in on a meeting. Small, repeated asks build a real role.
- Collect a written reference from your mentor before you leave. It is worth more than the certificate alone.
- Network inside the company - colleagues in other teams can point you to openings later.

> **The 50% milestone**
> At the halfway mark of your internship, three things unlock: your Participation Certificate (if you exit early), the company's ability to issue you a PPO or PO, and a natural moment to ask your mentor for a review. Plan for that milestone from day one.

17 Certificates, PPO and what comes after

PMIS is a bridge, not a destination. What you carry away from it - a certificate, a reference, a network and possibly a job offer - is the real return. Here is exactly what you can collect, and the rules around each.

The two certificates

Certificate	When you get it	What it proves
Participation Certificate	After at least 50% of the internship is completed (e.g. if you exit early for a job)	You took part and did substantial work
Completion Certificate	After 100% of the internship is completed	You finished the full programme

Both are issued through the portal by the company and MCA, carry a secure QR code for verification, and are downloadable from your own login. Interns must complete a short feedback survey before the download is enabled.

Pre-Placement Offers (PPO) and Placement Offers (PO)

Companies may voluntarily offer a PPO (a job to join after the internship) or a PO (a job with immediate joining) once you have completed at least 50% of the internship. These are optional and entirely at the company's discretion - they are not part of the scheme's guarantee. If you receive a PO and join the company, the portal records it as an 'early exit - offered PO', and that counts as a placement, not a dropout. You would still receive a Participation Certificate for the portion you completed.

If you accept a job elsewhere

You are not tied to your PMIS company. If you accept a full-time role at another organisation while interning, the company records it on the portal as 'Joined Full-Time Role - Other Company', and you can still receive your Participation Certificate if you completed at least 50%. Getting a job is a success for the scheme, not a failure of it.

> **What to ask for before you leave**
>
> A written reference or recommendation letter from your mentor, a note of the projects you worked on, and your mentor's contact for future references. The certificate proves you were there; the reference proves you were good.

18 PMIS compared: apprenticeships and other schemes

PMIS is not the only way to get early work experience in India, and it is worth knowing how it differs from the options next to it - because one of those options can actually disqualify you from PMIS.

Scheme	What it is	Key difference
PMIS	6 or 9-month paid internship in a company	Rs. 9,000 monthly stipend + Rs. 6,000 grant; certificate; not a job guarantee
NAPS / NATS apprenticeship	Apprenticeship under the Apprentices Act	Those who have completed NAPS or NATS training are excluded from PMIS
NITI Aayog internship	Unpaid/limited-stipend internship with government	Government exposure rather than corporate; different application route
Skill India courses	Short skilling and certification programmes	Classroom and skill certification, usually without a corporate placement

The one overlap to remember

If you have already completed an apprenticeship or training under the National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme (NAPS) or the National Apprenticeship Training Scheme (NATS) at any point, you are not eligible for PMIS. This is one of the scheme's hard filters. If you are weighing an apprenticeship against PMIS, factor this in - you generally cannot do both.

Which should you choose?

PMIS suits you if you want a real corporate setting, a defined monthly income, a certificate, and a reasonable chance of a job offer at the end. An apprenticeship suits you if you want a longer, more structured technical training with a trade qualification. A Skill India course suits you if you need a specific skill quickly. There is no single right answer - but if you are eligible for PMIS and have not yet done NAPS or NATS, it is one of the best-value options available to a young person in India today.

> **Do not stack schemes blindly**
>
> Before you commit to an apprenticeship or another government internship, check whether it would rule you out of PMIS. The exclusion for NAPS/NATS and the bar on holding another government internship at the same time are both easy to trip over.

19 The rules you must not break

PMIS has teeth. A handful of actions can end your participation - permanently. None of them are difficult to avoid once you know them, but they catch candidates who treat the scheme casually.

Action	Consequence
Accepting an offer and never joining (no action)	Marked Did Not Report (DNR) on day 15 after the reporting date plus grace period
Repeated offer lapses or rejections	Possible temporary restriction or ban on your account
Dropping out once	You get one more chance to join another PMIS internship
Dropping out a second time	Permanently ineligible to participate in PMIS
Being terminated by the company	You cannot participate in PMIS again
Giving false information in your profile	Companies may verify details; a false declaration can invalidate your application

How to exit cleanly

Life happens - you may get a better offer, or a family situation may change your plans. The clean way to exit is always to reject or withdraw on the portal rather than go silent. If you have accepted an offer and change your mind, act within the 15-day switch window or inform the company and the portal promptly. Genuine medical or family emergencies are reviewed case by case through the portal. What the system punishes is not changing your mind - it is disappearing.

One rule that surprises people

If a company terminates you during the internship, you are barred from PMIS for good - there is no second chance. Treat company rules on attendance, conduct and confidentiality as non-negotiable, especially in your first month.

20 Scams, fees and red flags

PMIS is completely free. There is no registration fee, no application fee, and no authorised agent. Because the scheme is well known and pays money, it attracts fraudsters. Learn the red flags now so you never pay to enter a free government scheme.

The absolute rule

Registration and application on the official portal are free. Any website, person or agency that asks you to pay for PMIS registration, or promises to 'get you an internship' for a fee, is not genuine. There is no third-party route into the scheme.

Red flags to walk away from

- Anyone asking for money to register, apply, or guarantee you an internship.
- A website that looks like the portal but is not pminternship.mca.gov.in or the official mobile app.
- Messages asking for your OTP, Aadhaar OTP, bank PIN or password. The portal will never ask for these by SMS or call.
- An 'agent' who says they have seats or can influence selection. Selection is done by companies through the portal.
- Links in WhatsApp or Telegram forwards that take you to a payment page.

How to verify anything

The only two official entry points are the portal at pminternship.mca.gov.in and the PMIS mobile app. The official helpline is 1800-11-6090 and the official email is pminternship@mca.gov.in. If you are ever unsure whether something is genuine, stop, and confirm through one of these before you share any information.

> **Protect your Aadhaar and OTP**
> Never share an OTP with anyone, even someone claiming to be from the scheme or the government. The portal sends OTPs only to verify your own actions on your own device. If someone asks you to read out an OTP, it is a scam - end the call.

21 The 10 mistakes that cost youth their internship

These are the recurring, avoidable errors seen across the pilot rounds - each one has cost real candidates a real internship. Read them once, then check your own plan against them.

1. **Applying while enrolled in a full-time course.** Unless you are a final-year student with a NoC, this makes your application invalid.
2. **Using an excluded qualification.** MBA, CA, CMA, CS, MBBS, BDS, PhD or an IIT/IIM/NLU/IISER/NID/IIIT/IISc degree disqualifies you.
3. **Applying to internships far from home.** Location is the number-one reason offers are declined - do not apply to places you will not actually go.
4. **Leaving your profile incomplete.** Incomplete profiles get skipped by the matching engine before any human sees them.
5. **Applying to roles you are clearly underqualified for.** It wastes your three slots and lowers your response rate.
6. **Applying to only one internship.** Use your slots, spread across companies and cities.
7. **Not checking the dashboard.** Offers lapse on day 15 if you take no action.
8. **Accepting an offer you will not honour.** Accepting and then not joining leads to DNR and account restrictions.
9. **Forgetting to seed your Aadhaar with your bank account.** Your stipend and grant get stuck.
10. **Paying someone to help you apply.** The scheme is free; paying is a scam.

> **The pattern behind all ten**
> Every one of these mistakes comes from treating PMIS as a form to fill rather than a process to run. The candidates who win are the ones who read the rules once and then follow through, calmly, to the end.

22 Your 30-day action plan

Here is a realistic four-week plan that takes you from 'I have heard of PMIS' to 'my applications are in and I am ready for an offer'. You can compress it, but do not skip the eligibility check.

Week 1 - Get eligible and get in

- Confirm your eligibility against the list in Section 3, including the income limit and the exclusions.
- Get your Aadhaar seeded to your bank account (this takes time - start now).
- Register on pminternship.mca.gov.in with your Aadhaar-linked mobile number.
- Complete e-KYC via Aadhaar OTP or DigiLocker.
- If you are a final-year student, request your NoC from your institution.

Week 2 - Build a profile that gets shortlisted

- Fill every field in your profile, including skills, languages and bio.
- Upload your Aadhaar, certificates and photograph.
- Add any certifications you have (SWAYAM, NPTEL, sector courses).
- Prepare a clean one-page resume.
- Set your sector and location preferences realistically.

Week 3 - Apply, and apply well

- Browse live internships and shortlist the ones that match your qualification and are within reach.
- Use all three active application slots, spread across companies and cities.
- Read each listing fully before applying.
- Set a daily habit: check dashboard, email and phone once a day.

Week 4 - Convert

- Respond to any company contact within hours, not days.
- Prepare your 60-second introduction and a little company knowledge.
- If an offer arrives, read the letter, then accept or reject within 14 days.
- On joining, carry your documents and your Aadhaar-seeded account details.

> **Keep the loop turning**
> If your first applications do not convert, that is normal - simply replace them with new ones as slots free up. The scheme is rolling, so persistence is rewarded. Most youth quit after one or two attempts; the ones who keep applying are the ones who get placed.

23 Questions youth actually ask (FAQ)

Is PMIS a job?

No. It is a paid internship of 6 or 9 months. It does not guarantee employment, though a company may voluntarily offer you a PPO or PO after 50% completion.

How much will I be paid?

Rs. 9,000 per month - Rs. 900 from the company and Rs. 8,100 from the government via DBT - plus a one-time Rs. 6,000 grant paid in two tranches of Rs. 3,000.

Does it cost anything to apply?

No. Registration and application on the official portal are completely free. There is no authorised agent, and anyone charging a fee is not genuine.

What is the age limit?

18 to 25 years on the date of application. This was widened from 21-24 in March 2026.

Can final-year students apply?

Yes. Final-year students of full-time graduation or post-graduation are eligible since March 2026, but you must upload a No-Objection Certificate (NoC) from your institution.

Can I apply if I already have a master's degree?

Yes - postgraduates became eligible in March 2026. But an MBA or equivalent management qualification is excluded.

I studied at an IIT/IIM. Am I eligible?

No. Graduates of IITs, IIMs, NLUs, IISER, NID, IIIT and IISc, and holders of CA, CMA, CS, MBBS, BDS, MBA or PhD, are excluded.

How long is the internship?

6 or 9 months, based on the company's requirement. Interns from earlier pilot rounds continue on the older 12-month duration.

How many internships can I apply to?

Up to 3 active applications at any one time. If one is rejected, you can apply to another - but never more than 3 active at once.

How many offers can I hold?

Up to 2 active offers at one time, but you can accept only 1.

How long do I have to accept an offer?

14 days. If you take no action, the offer lapses automatically on day 15.

Can I switch if I get a second offer?

Yes, but only within 15 days of accepting the first offer.

What if I accept and then cannot join?

You get a 14-day grace period after the reporting date. If you still do not join, you are marked Did Not Report (DNR) on day 15, which can restrict your account.

What happens if I drop out?

You get one more chance to join another PMIS internship. If you drop out a second time, you become permanently ineligible.

Will I get a certificate?

Yes. A Participation Certificate after at least 50% completion, or a Completion Certificate after 100% completion. Both carry a QR code and are downloadable from your login.

Will I get a job at the end?

Not guaranteed. Companies may voluntarily issue a PPO or PO after 50% completion, but this is at their discretion.

Do I get insurance?

Yes. Free life and personal-accident insurance equivalent to PMJJBY and PMSBY, with the premium paid by the government. A company may add more.

How is the stipend paid?

By Direct Benefit Transfer to your Aadhaar-seeded bank account. Seed your Aadhaar to your account before you join, or payments will be delayed.

What documents do I need?

Aadhaar, educational certificates, a bank account seeded with Aadhaar, and - for final-year students - an institutional NoC. A photograph is optional.

Is there an entrance exam?

No. There is no exam. Selection is profile-based; some companies add a short assessment or interview.

Where do I apply?

Only at pminternship.mca.gov.in or through the official PMIS mobile app.

Who do I contact for help?

Use the portal's Need Help chat, raise a ticket via Home > Support, or file a grievance in the Complaints section. Helpline: 1800-11-6090. Email: pminternship@mca.gov.in.

How current is this information?

It reflects the revised PMIS guidelines of 12 March 2026 and Round III, which is live until December 2026. Always confirm on the portal before acting.

24 Templates you can copy

Three short templates you can adapt in a couple of minutes. Keep them simple and honest.

1. Your 60-second self-introduction

"My name is [name]. I have completed [Class 12 / diploma / B.Com / B.Tech] from [institution]. I am interested in [sector] because [one honest reason]. I have [one skill or project]. I am applying for this internship to get real experience in [role], and I am ready to relocate or commute to [location]."

2. A short follow-up message after applying

"Respected Sir/Madam, I applied for the [role] internship under the PM Internship Scheme on [date]. I am [name], a [qualification] from [place]. I remain very interested in the role and available to join from [date]. Thank you for your consideration."

3. A grievance you can adapt on the portal

Category: [DBT / Internship / Portal]. "My name is [name] and my PMIS application ID is [id]. On [date], [describe the issue clearly, in one or two sentences - e.g. my joining was confirmed but the first instalment of the Rs. 6,000 grant has not been credited]. I have attached [supporting files]. Kindly help resolve this."

> **Keep records**
> Save screenshots of every application, offer letter and payment confirmation, and note the dates. If you ever need to raise a grievance, dates and screenshots are what get things resolved quickly.

25 Glossary of portal terms

PMIS - Prime Minister's Internship Scheme, run by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs.

e-KYC - Electronic identity verification, done on the portal via Aadhaar OTP or DigiLocker.

DBT - Direct Benefit Transfer - government money paid straight to your Aadhaar-seeded bank account.

Aadhaar seeding - Linking your Aadhaar number to your bank account so DBT payments reach you.

Active application - An application still in progress (applied, shortlisted, waitlisted, selected, accepted or joined).

Rolling model - Companies post internships continuously rather than in one fixed window.

NoC - No-Objection Certificate - a letter from your institution, required for final-year students.

PPO - Pre-Placement Offer - a job offer to join after the internship, possible after 50% completion.

PO - Placement Offer - a job offer with immediate joining, possible after 50% completion.

QPR - Quarterly Progress Report - the company uploads a report on your progress each quarter.

DNR - Did Not Report - the status if you accept an offer but never join.

Participation Certificate - Issued after at least 50% of the internship is completed.

Completion Certificate - Issued after 100% of the internship is completed.

CSR funds - Corporate Social Responsibility funds - the source of the company's Rs. 900 monthly share.

Network entity - A company in a partner firm's supply chain or group that can also host interns.

26 Official links and sources

Use only these official channels. Anything else is not the scheme.

Resource	Where to find it
Official PMIS portal	pminternship.mca.gov.in
Official mobile app	PMIS app (launched 17 March 2025) on the official app stores
Ministry	Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA), Government of India
Helpline (multilingual)	1800-11-6090
Official email	pminternship@mca.gov.in
Grievance	Portal dashboard > Complaints section
Scheme details	myscheme.gov.in/schemes/pmis

Sources behind this handbook

PMIS portal candidate and company manuals; Ministry of Corporate Affairs PMIS Pilot Project guidelines, including the revised Office Memorandum dated 12 March 2026; University Grants Commission PMIS guidelines; Press Information Bureau releases; and official replies in the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha during 2026 (including data as of 15 July 2026). Figures quoted carry their dates where they are time-sensitive.

A final word

PMIS is one of the few schemes that pays you to learn. The rules are clear, the money is real, and the door is open to youth who would otherwise struggle to get a first corporate line on their resume. Read the rules once, apply carefully, follow through - and you will be ahead of the thousands who register and then disappear.

27 Quick reference: the whole scheme on one page

Rs. 9,000
MONTHLY
Rs. 8,100 govt + Rs. 900 company

Rs. 6,000
JOINING GRANT
Two tranches of Rs. 3,000

6 or 9
MONTHS
Internship duration

The essentials	The detail
Age	18 to 25 on the date of application
Who can apply	Class 10/12, ITI, diploma, graduate, or postgraduate (final-year allowed with NoC)
Who cannot	MBA/CA/CMA/CS/MBBS/BDS/PhD; IIT/IIM/NLU/IISER/NID/IIIT/IISc grads; NAPS/NATS completers; family in a permanent govt job
Income limit	Family income under Rs. 12 lakh a year
Where to apply	pminternship.mca.gov.in (or the official PMIS app)
Cost	Free - no fee, ever
Application limit	3 active applications at a time
Offer limit	2 offers at a time, accept only 1, within 14 days
After joining	Seed Aadhaar to your bank account for DBT
Certificate	Participation after 50%, Completion after 100%
Help	Helpline 1800-11-6090 | pminternship@mca.gov.in

The five-step version

1. Check eligibility. 2. Register free and complete Aadhaar e-KYC. 3. Build a 100% complete profile. 4. Apply to 3 internships you would genuinely join. 5. Accept within 14 days, seed your bank account, join on time, and finish what you start.